Kindergarten report card comments

Pick two or three skills. For each, use a **strength** or **on track** line, then at most one **next step** and one thing to try **at home**. Swap [Name] and "their" for the child's name and pronoun. In the first quarter, "on track" is the honest word for most children: kindergarten standards describe the end of the year.

Reading

Letter names

- **STRENGTH** [Name] knows the names of all 26 letters, capital and lowercase.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] names every letter of the alphabet quickly, in and out of order.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] knows most capital letters and is learning the lowercase ones.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] can name the letters in their own name and many more.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is learning the names of the letters, starting with the ones in their name, which we're practicing with daily letter games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could point out letters on signs, food boxes and books and ask [Name] to name them.

Letter sounds

- **STRENGTH** [Name] knows the sound for every letter and uses them to sound out new words.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] matches letters to their sounds quickly and confidently.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] knows the sounds for many letters and is adding new ones each week.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning letter sounds and remembers the ones we have practiced.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is matching each letter to its sound, which we're practicing with a short phonics lesson every day.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could play I Spy with sounds ("I spy something that starts with /m/").

Rhyming and hearing sounds in words

- **STRENGTH** [Name] hears rhymes easily and loves making up silly rhyming words.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] can clap the syllables in long words and hear the first sound in a word.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is starting to hear words that rhyme and enjoys rhyming songs.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] can clap the syllables in their name and is learning to hear first sounds.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is hearing the sounds inside words, like the rhyme in cat and hat, which we're practicing with songs, rhymes and listening games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could read rhyming books and pause so [Name] can say the rhyming word.

Sight words

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads all of our sight words so far and spots them in books.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] has learned their sight words quickly and uses them in writing.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads several of our sight words and is learning a few more each week.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] recognizes some sight words, such as "the" and "is", in books.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is learning our sight words (short words like "the", "is" and "you"), which we're practicing with word games and spotting the words in books.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look for this week's sight words when you read together.

Enjoying books and print

- **STRENGTH** [Name] loves books, retells stories in order and points to the words while reading along.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] holds books the right way, follows the words left to right and talks about the pictures.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] enjoys listening to stories and is learning to retell what happened.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning that we read from left to right and that words are separated by spaces.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is retelling a story: what happened at the beginning, middle and end, which we're practicing after our class read-alouds.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could read together for ten minutes and ask what happened first.

Writing and fine motor

Writing

- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes their name and labels their drawings using the sounds in each word.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes simple sentences and is starting to leave spaces between words.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] writes their first name and is beginning to add letters to their drawings.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] draws detailed pictures and is learning to write a word or two about them.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is writing their name and adding a word or label to their drawings, which we're practicing in our daily writing time.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could let [Name] write shopping lists, cards or labels, however the spelling comes out.

Pencil grip and cutting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] holds a pencil with a good grip and cuts carefully along lines.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] has strong fine motor skills and forms many letters neatly.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is developing a steadier pencil grip and getting more confident with scissors.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building the hand strength for writing through play-dough, beads and puzzles.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is a comfortable pencil grip and cutting along a line, which we're practicing with threading, tracing and snipping activities.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could try play-dough, Lego, peg games or cutting old magazines.

Math

Counting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] counts to 100 by ones and tens with confidence.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] counts well past 20 and can count on from any number.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] counts to 20 and is working towards higher numbers.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] counts objects carefully, touching each one while counting.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is counting objects one at a time, touching each one once, which we're practicing with counting games and real objects.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could count stairs, toys or snacks together and ask "how many?".

Number recognition and writing

- **STRENGTH** [Name] recognizes and writes numbers to 20.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads numbers to 20 and matches each one to the right number of objects.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] recognizes numbers to 10 and is learning to write them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to read the numbers 11 to 20.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is recognizing and writing numbers to 10, which we're practicing in small-group math games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could spot numbers on doors, buses and clocks when you are out.

Adding and taking away

- **STRENGTH** [Name] adds and takes away within 10 using objects and fingers, and explains how.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves simple story problems and shows their thinking with drawings.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is beginning to add small groups of objects together.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] can show "one more" and "one less" with objects.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is putting groups together and taking some away with real objects, which we're practicing with counters and story problems.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could make little story problems with snacks ("you have 3 grapes and I give you 2 more").

Shapes and patterns

- **STRENGTH** [Name] names circles, squares, triangles and rectangles and finds them all around the room.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] makes and continues patterns and describes shapes by their sides and corners.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] names the common shapes and is learning to describe them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is starting to copy and continue simple patterns.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is naming shapes and continuing simple patterns, which we're practicing with building, sorting and pattern games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could go on a shape hunt around the house or make patterns with spoons and forks.

Social and emotional

Speaking and listening

- **STRENGTH** [Name] speaks clearly in full sentences and asks thoughtful questions.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] listens carefully at group time and shares ideas with the class.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is growing in confidence when speaking in a group.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to listen and wait for their turn to talk at group time.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is sharing their ideas at group time in a full sentence, which we're practicing with turn-taking games and talk partners.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask about their day with open questions ("what made you laugh today?").

Friendships and sharing

- **STRENGTH** [Name] is kind to everyone, includes others in games and shares readily.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] plays well with others, takes turns and helps classmates.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is making friends and learning to share and take turns.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] plays happily alongside others and is starting to join in group games.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is taking turns and sharing in play, which we're practicing with turn-taking games and practicing kind words.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could play simple board games that need turn-taking.

Managing feelings

- **STRENGTH** [Name] manages their feelings well and uses words to explain what is wrong.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] bounces back quickly from small upsets and helps others when they are sad.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to name their feelings and to ask for help when upset.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at calming down with a deep breath or a quiet moment.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is naming their feelings and using a calm-down strategy when upset, which we're practicing with our feelings chart and calm corner.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk about feelings in stories ("how do you think the bear feels?").

Routines and independence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] follows our class routines independently and loves to help.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] manages their belongings and gets ready for each activity without reminders.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning our routines and needs fewer reminders each week.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is becoming more independent with coats, lunch and tidying up.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is following two-step directions and tidying up independently, which we're practicing with picture schedules and lots of practice.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could give two-step jobs ("put your shoes away, then wash your hands").

Needs-improvement comments, rewritten kindly

Instead of	Write
Maya can't write her name.	Maya is learning to write her name and can already write the M. We practice name writing every morning.
Leo is behind in reading.	Leo knows 12 letter names and is adding new ones each week. Our next step is the rest of the alphabet, starting with the letters in his name.
Sam is immature and cries a lot.	Sam is learning to name their feelings and to ask a grown-up for help when upset. We use our calm corner and feelings chart every day.
Ava never listens at carpet time.	Ava is working on listening at group time and waiting for her turn to talk. A short, clear signal and sitting near the front help her.
Noah is very disruptive.	Noah has lots of energy and great ideas. Our next step is keeping his hands to himself at carpet time, and movement breaks between activities are helping.
Zara refuses to share.	Zara is learning to take turns and share in play. We practice with turn-taking games, and she is starting to offer toys to friends.
Eli is lazy about tidying up.	Eli is becoming more independent at tidy-up time and does best with one job at a time ("put the blocks in the blue box").
Ruby's counting is weak compared to the class.	Ruby counts to 10 confidently and is learning to touch each object once as she counts. Counting snacks or stairs at home helps a lot.
Omar may have a speech delay.	Don't write it. Talk to the family in person and follow your school's process (speech-language screening, the student support team). The report can say: "Omar is growing in confidence when speaking in a group."
Since his parents split up, Theo has been unsettled.	Leave family circumstances out. "Theo is getting better at calming down with a deep breath or a quiet moment, and is settling well into our morning routine."
Priya is the youngest in the class, so she finds things harder.	Priya has grown in confidence this quarter and is learning our routines. She needs fewer reminders each week.
Jonah's phonemic awareness and CVC blending are emerging.	Jonah can hear the first sound in a word and is starting to sound out short words like "cat" and "sun".

102 lines. Free from polytheseus.com/teacher-skills/guides/kindergarten-report-card-comments, where a free builder puts them together and checks the wording. Drafted with AI help: read every line against what you know of the child and your school's report rules before you use it. If you're worried about a child's development, talk to the family in person first.